



Apple MacBook

Apple, anyone?

With the Intel Core Duo CPU at 2 GHz instead of the PowerPC G4 and a matte black finish, the ultra-portable MacBook is a far cry from its predecessor, the iBook. The RAM is 512 MB DDR2, and the hard disk, 80 GB. A glossy screen enriches the viewing experience, but also makes it very reflective. The 13.3-inch display with a maximum resolution of 1280 x 800 is powered by Intel's GMA 950 integrated graphics. The optical drive is a slot-loading Super Drive

DVD±RW. All ports are located on the left.

Connectivity options include USB 2.0, FireWire, audio in/out ports, and RJ-45. Wireless connectivity provided by the AirPort Extreme supports 802.11g. There is a mini-DVI port to connect a large-format display or a TV. There is, however, no expansion slot for PCMCIA or Express cards. A card reader, another standard on all PC laptops, is missing.

Featured here is the integrated iSight camera for videoconferencing; the cam delivers very good video quality. The MacBook comes with a great software bundle. All the usual utilities are there, plus the iLife 06 application suite, which lets you create and edit movies,



manage photo albums, create your own music, and create Web pages.

The MacBook played our test video for 154 minutes—at par with other laptops.

For all you Mac fans out there, this is a great buy. As for Windows die-hards—give the MacBook a shot, and you just might not feel like going back!

Specifications

Core Duo 2 GHz, 512 MB DDR2 RAM, 80 GB HDD, Super Drive DVD±RW, 13.3-inch wide-screen, iSight camera

Contact: Apple International

Phone: 080-25550575

E-mail: indiainfo@asia.apple.com

Web site: www.apple.co.in

Price: Rs 87,600

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Palit 7600GT

Just a decent graphics card

Palit's 7600GT is based on a stock G73 core. 3D Mark 2006 gave us a score of 3220—not bad. The 7600GT coughed up 6290 3D Marks in 3D Mark 2005. F.E.A.R. gave 28 fps at 1280 x 960 with 4x AF and AA off.



Soft Shadows were enabled here; with SS off, we got 41 fps. In comparison, we got 27, 6284 and 3422 in F.E.A.R., 3D Mark 2005, and 3D Mark 2006 respectively on an Asus GeForce 7600GT.

This is a fairly decent product that manages to do what other cards based on this core do, without any really outstanding features.

Specifications

Core: GeForce 7600 GT (G73), 560 MHz core speed, 1400 MHz memory speed, 12 pixel pipelines, 5 vertex pipelines, Shader Model 3.0 / OpenGL 2.0 compliant, 256 MB GDDR3

Contact: Shree Sagarmatha

Distributors Pvt Ltd

Phone: 011-26428541

E-mail: techcom@airtelbroadband.in

Web site: www.palit.com.tw

Price: Rs 8,990

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build quality	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Western Digital My Book 500 GB Premium Edition

The Big Daddy of the externals!

This external drive has a unique design that resembles a medium-sized reference book. The design is quite sturdy. The drive has a dual interface—USB 2.0 as well as FireWire.

There's a round button that lets you take backups from the drive; this works in conjunction with the bundled Retrospect backup software. This button also indicates free space.

Writing a 1 GB file to the drive took just 44 seconds; reading took 35, which is quite fast.



Specifications

500 GB, interfaces: USB 2.0 and FireWire, dimensions: 17.2 cm (H) x 14.3 cm (D) x 5.7 cm (W), weight: 1.32 kg, Retrospect backup software

Contact: Western Digital

Phone: 9321029204

E-mail: amarjit.singh@wdc.com

Web site: www.wdc.com

Price: Rs 17,500

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build quality	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★